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React JSX

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What is JSX?

JSX stands for JavaScript XML.

JSX allows us to write HTML in React.

JSX makes it easier to write and add HTML in React.

Coding JSX

JSX allows us to write HTML elements in JavaScript and place them in the DOM without any `createElement()` and/or `appendChild()` methods.

JSX converts HTML tags into react elements.

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Here are two examples. The first uses JSX and the second does not:

Example 1

Get your own React.js Server

JSX:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = <h1>I Love JSX!</h1>;

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  myElement
);
```

Run Example »

Example 2

Without JSX:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = React.createElement('h1', {}, 'I do not use JSX!');

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  myElement
);
```

Run Example »

As you can see in the first example, JSX allows us to write HTML directly within the JavaScript code.

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Expressions in JSX

With JSX you can write expressions inside curly braces `{ }`.

The expression can be a React variable, or property, or any other valid JavaScript expression. JSX will execute the expression and return the result:

Example

Execute the expression `5 + 5`:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = <h1>React is {5 + 5} times better with JSX</h1>;
```

Run Example »

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Example

Create a list with three list items:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = (
  <ul>
    <li>Apples</li>
    <li>Bananas</li>
    <li>Cherries</li>
  </ul>
);
```

Run Example »

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So if you like to write *two* paragraphs, you must put them inside a parent element, like a `div` element.

Example

Wrap two paragraphs inside one DIV element:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = (
  <div>
    <p>I am a paragraph.</p>
    <p>I am a paragraph too.</p>
  </div>
);
```

Run Example »

JSX will throw an error if the HTML is not correct, or if the HTML misses a parent element.

Alternatively, you can use a "fragment" to wrap multiple lines. This will prevent unnecessarily adding extra nodes to the DOM.

A fragment looks like an empty HTML tag: `<></>`.

Example

Wrap two paragraphs inside a fragment:

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```
    <p>I am a paragraph.</p>
    <p>I am a paragraph too.</p>
  </>
);
```

Run Example »

Elements Must be Closed

JSX follows XML rules, and therefore HTML elements must be properly closed.

Example

Close empty elements with `/>`

main.jsx

```
const myElement = <input type="text" />;
```

Run Example »

JSX will throw an error if the HTML is not properly closed.

Attribute class = className

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Use attribute `className` instead.

JSX solved this by using `className` instead. When JSX is rendered, it translates `className` attributes into `class` attributes.

Example

Use attribute `className` instead of `class` in JSX:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = <h1 className="myclass">Hello World</h1>;
```

Run Example »

Comments in JSX

Comments in JSX are written with `{/* */}`

Example

Comments in JSX:

main.jsx

```
const myElement = <h1>Hello {/* Wonderful */} World </h1>;
```

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JSX in React Components

React uses components to build UIs. Components are independent and reusable bits of code.

React components are like JavaScript functions, and return HTML.

JSX works perfect inside React components

Example

JSX in Components:

main.jsx

```
function Car() {
  return (
    <>
      <h2>My Car</h2>
      <p>It is a Ford Mustang.</p>
    </>
  );
}

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <Car />
)
```

Run Example »

Inside the components, you can do some other operations before returning the HTML:

Example

```
function Car() {
  const brand = "Ford";
  const model = "Mustang";
  return (
    <>
      <h2>My Car</h2>
      <p>It is a {brand} {model}.</p>
    </>
  );
}

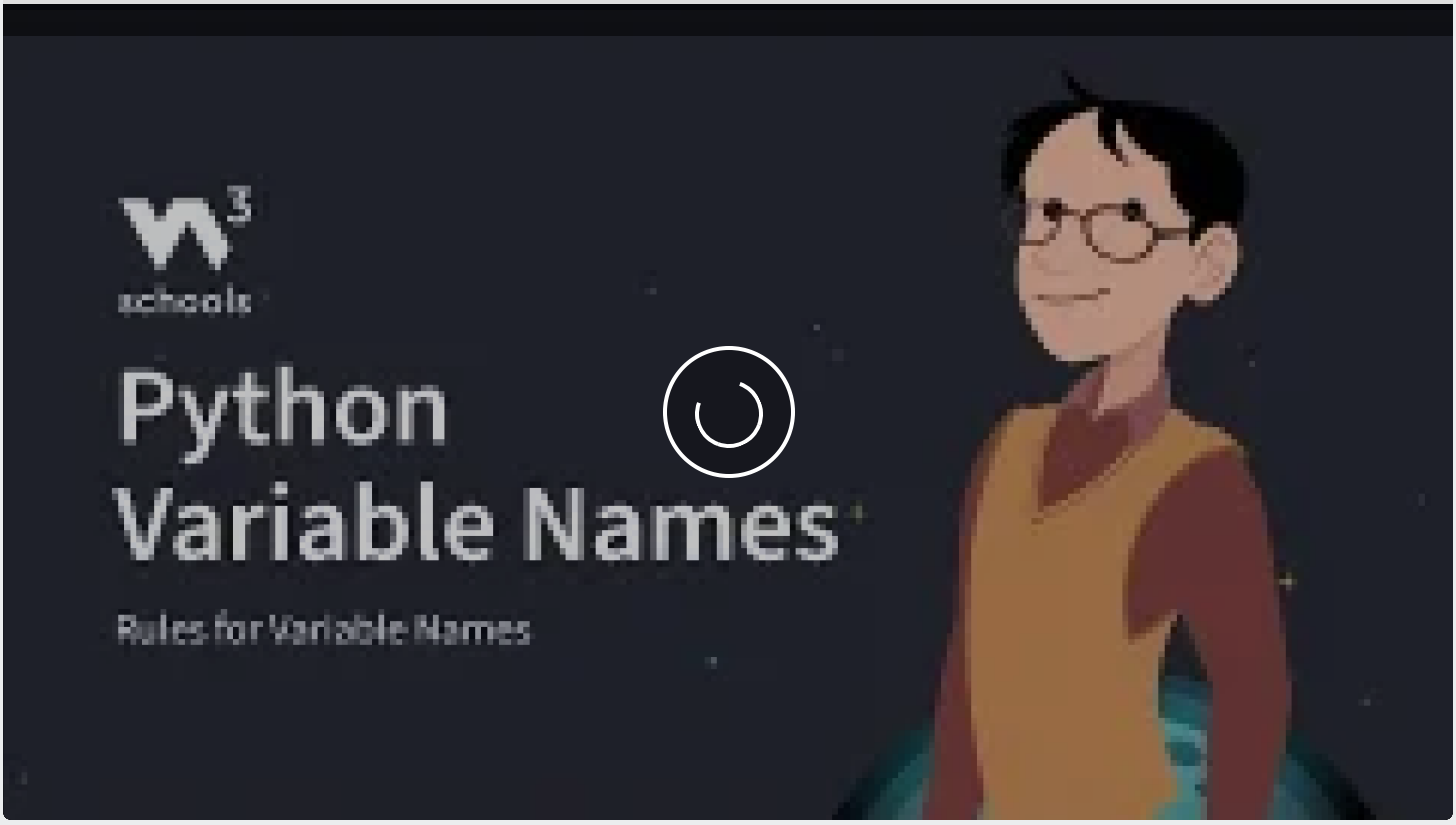
createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <Car />
)
```

Run Example »

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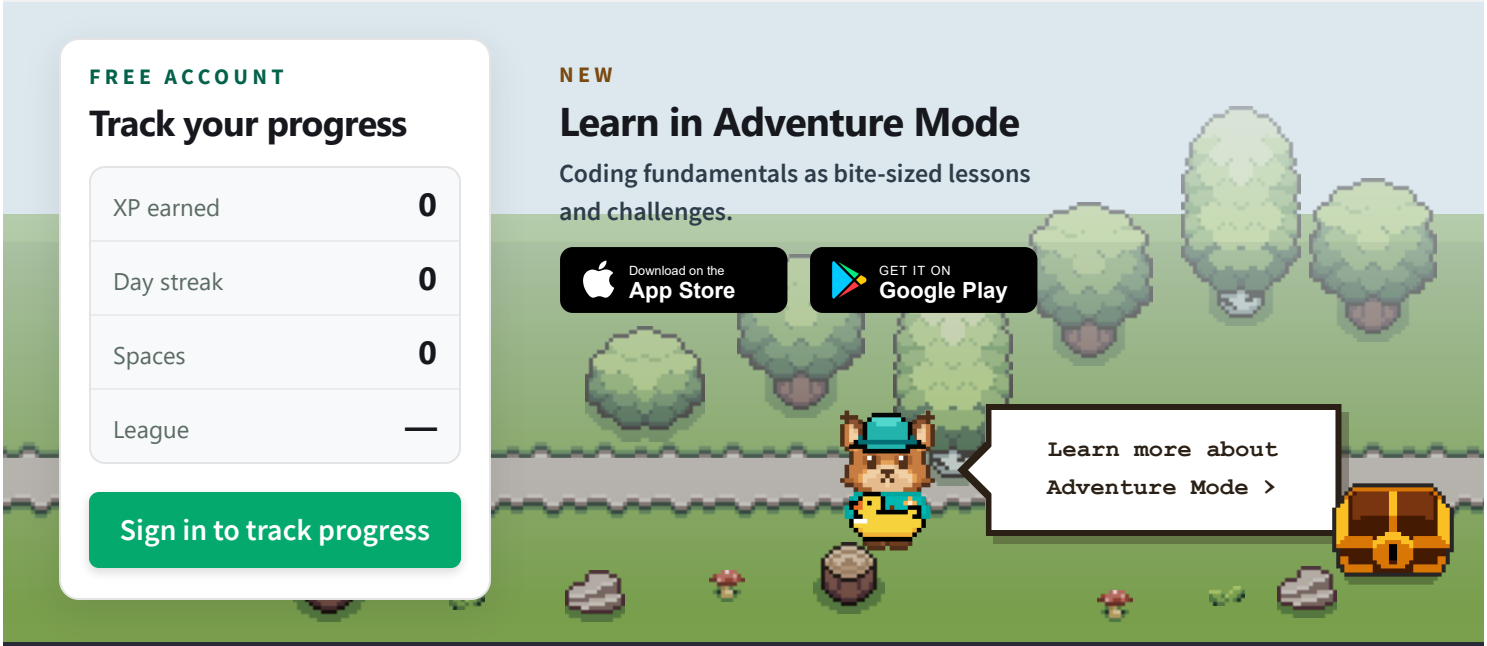
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